TikTok Fact Checking

Overview

TikTok

Welcome to the US TikTok Fact-Checking Program!



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TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

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TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

TikTok

https://www.tiktok.com/community-guidelines

Introduction

Minor Safety

Dangerous acts and challenges

Suicide, self-harm, and disordered eating

Adult nudity and sexual activities

Bullying and harassment

Hateful behavior

Violent extremism

Integrity and authenticity

Illegal activities and regulated goods

Violent and graphic content

Copyright and trademark infringement

Platform security

Harmful misinformation

Misinformation is defined as content that is inaccurate or false. We will remove misinformation that causes significant harm to individuals, our community, or the larger public regardless of intent. Significant harm includes serious physical injury, illness, or death; severe psychological trauma; large-scale property damage, and the undermining of public trust in civic institutions and processes such as governments, elections, and scientific bodies. This does not include simply inaccurate information, myths, or commercial or reputational harm.

Do not post, upload, stream, or share:

- Misinformation that incites hate or prejudice
- Misinformation related to emergencies that induces panic
- Medical misinformation that can cause harm to an individual's physical health
- Content that misleads community members about elections or other civic processes
- Conspiratorial content including content that attacks a specific person or a protected group, includes a violent call to action, or denies a violent or tragic event occurred
- Digital Forgeries (Synthetic Media or Manipulated Media) that mislead users by distorting the truth of events and cause significant harm to the subject of the video, other persons, or society

Do not:

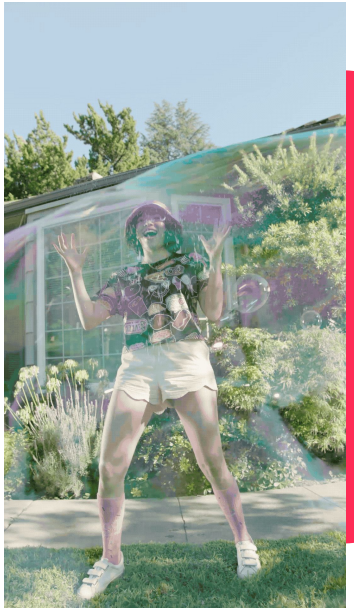
- Engage in coordinated inauthentic behavior such as the use of multiple accounts to exert influence and sway public opinion while misleading individuals, our community, or our systems about the

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TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

We believe that trust forms the foundation of our community. We do not allow activities that may undermine the integrity or authenticity of our platform or our users.

We **remove** content or accounts that involve spam or fake engagement, impersonation, or **misleading information that causes harm**.

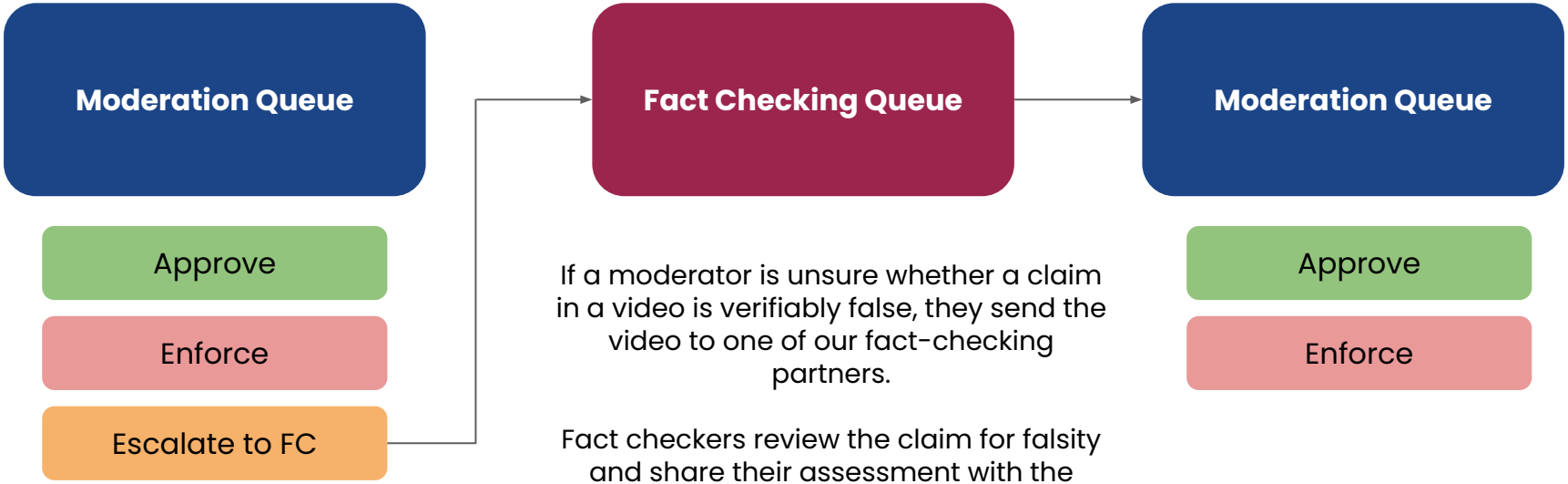


We define misinformation as content that is inaccurate or false.

While we encourage our community to have conversations about subjects that matter to them, we **do not permit misinformation that causes harm** to individuals, our community, or the larger public **regardless of intent.**

Process Flow

We rely on our fact checking partners as experts to help our moderation teams assess whether a video includes misinformation that violates TikTok's Community Guidelines.



How TikTok Uses Fact-Checker Assessments

1. **Determine whether content violates TikTok's misinformation policies:** TikTok moderators and policy team use the categories and sub-classifications that fact-checkers select to determine whether the content violates TikTok's misinformation policies and should be removed from recommendation feeds or removed from the platform.

2. **Track trends:** We rely heavily on fact-checkers to help us track misinformation trends across languages and markets and understand how we can bolster our systems to address them.

3. **Identify policy gaps:** We leverage fact-checker insights to help understand whether there might be gaps in our misinformation policies or procedures preventing us from addressing harmful misinformation.

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Steps to Fact Check Content on TikTok



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Step 1: Download Lark

LARK

- Lark is a communications tool similar to Slack, Google Chat and Microsoft Teams.
- Partners will need to download and login to Lark, in order to communicate with the TikTok team and access the fact-checking tool.

- Please send us the list of names, along with emails addresses and location for us to send them a Lark invite.

- They will need to download and login to Lark using their email address (no personal email addresses).

Step 2: Download TCS

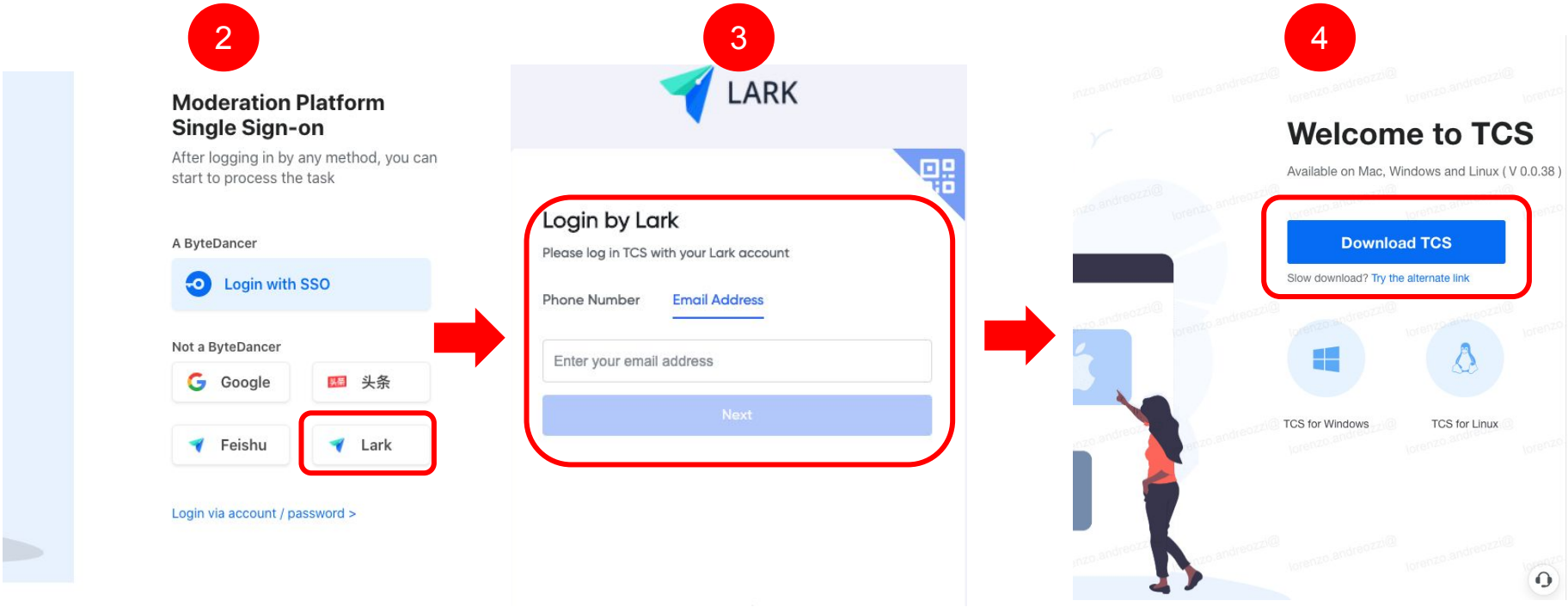


Task Crowdsourcing

- TCS (Task Crowdsourcing) is an internal TikTok tool used by both the moderation and fact checking teams.
- This will be the primary tool to fact checking content on TikTok.

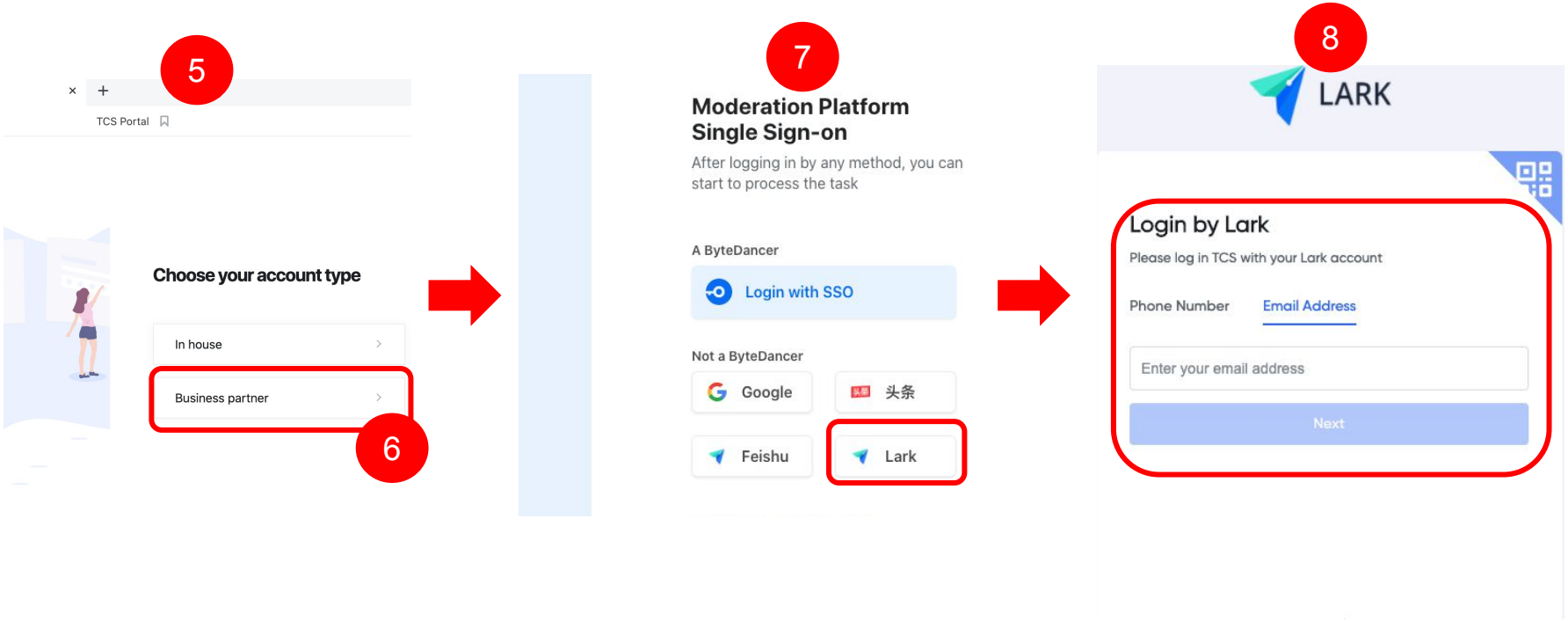
Step 2: Download TCS

1. Copy and paste this url to the search bar of your browser: https://tcs.tiktokv-us.com/worktable/favor
2. Select “Feishu” or “Lark”; after that you’ll be redirected to a login page
3. When you are in the login page, use your credentials to access the download app page
4. Click on “Download TCS” and install the app (full instruction for installation will be provided)

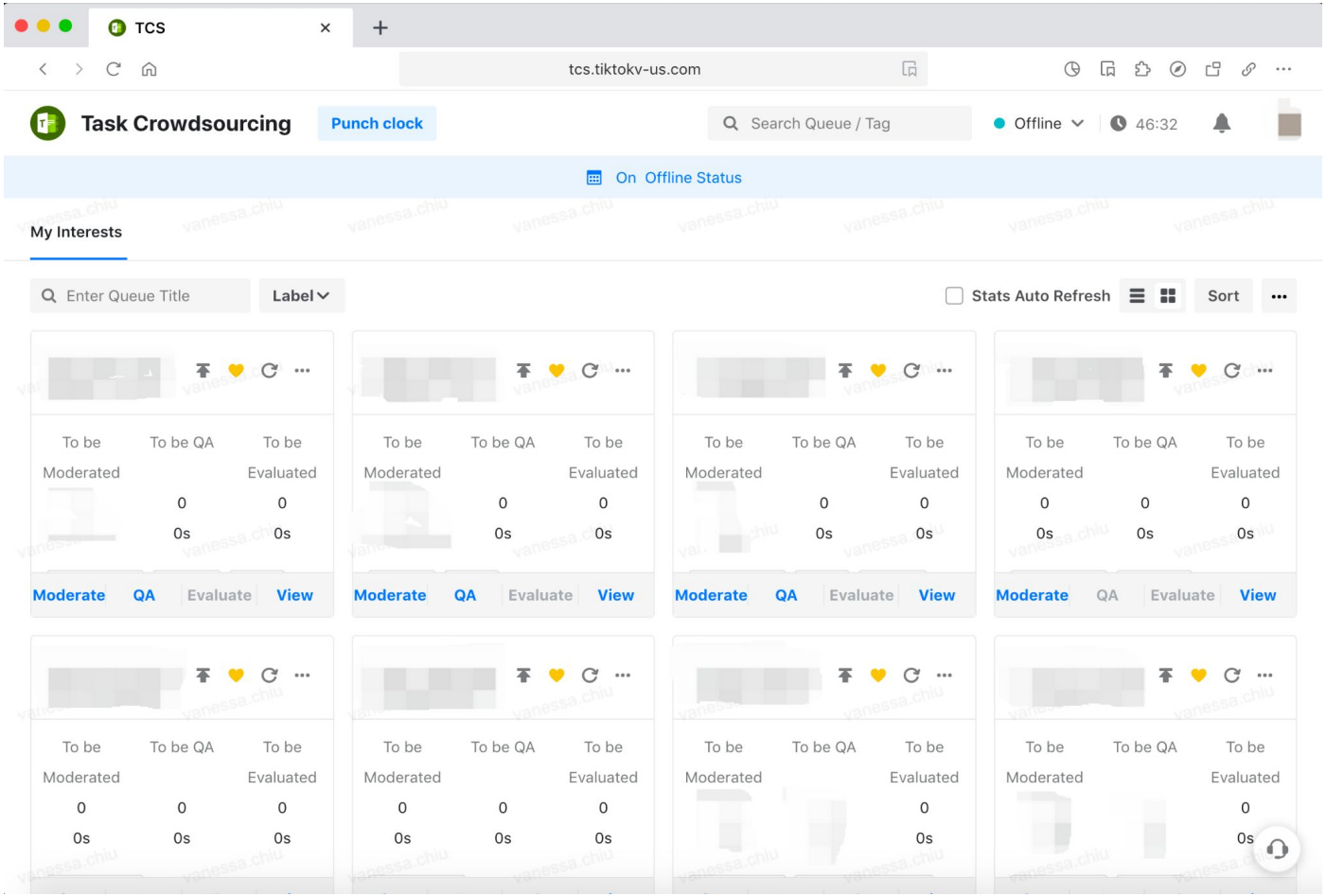


Step 3: Login to TCS

1. Once you have installed the app, open it and you will see the “Choose your account type” landing page
2. Select “Business partner”
3. Select “Lark”; after that you’ll be redirected to a login page
4. When you are in the login page use your credentials to access the TCS platform

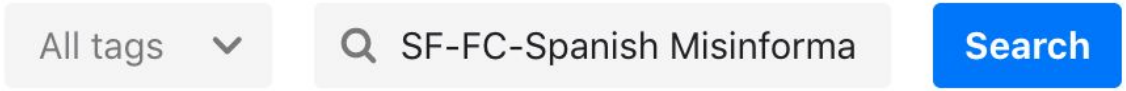


Welcome to TCS!

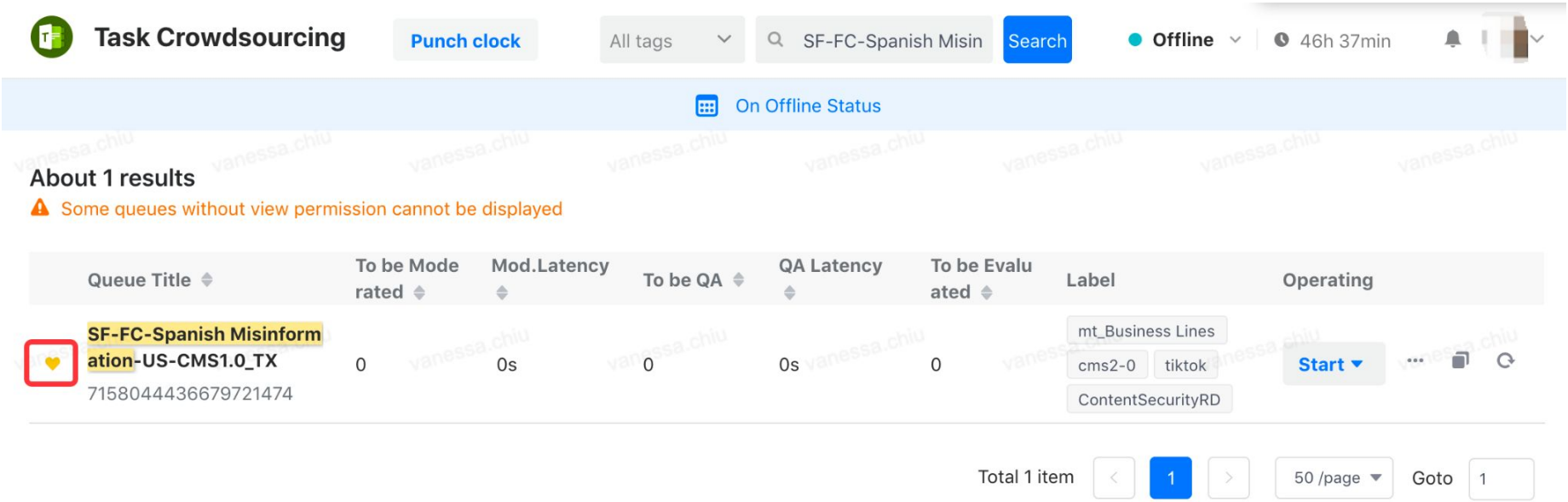


Step 4: Pin Queues

1. Search the queue in TCS by entering the queue name or queue ID in the search bar (top right)

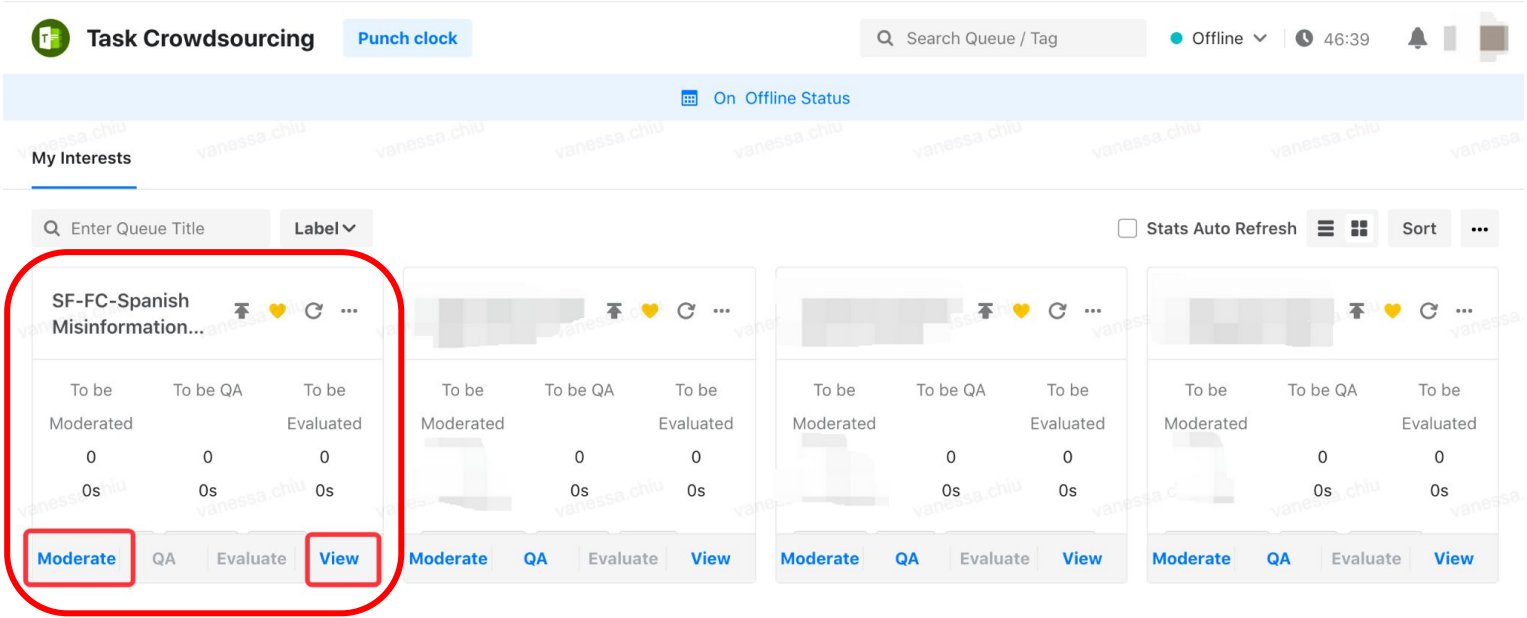


2. Select “Search” and you will find the queue; at this point click on the “heart” beside the queue name



Step 5: Start Fact Checking!

3. Go back to the homepage and you will see the queue displayed on your homepage



Select “Moderate” to fact-check content in the queue; click “View” to check content in the queue

TCS Fact Checking Overview



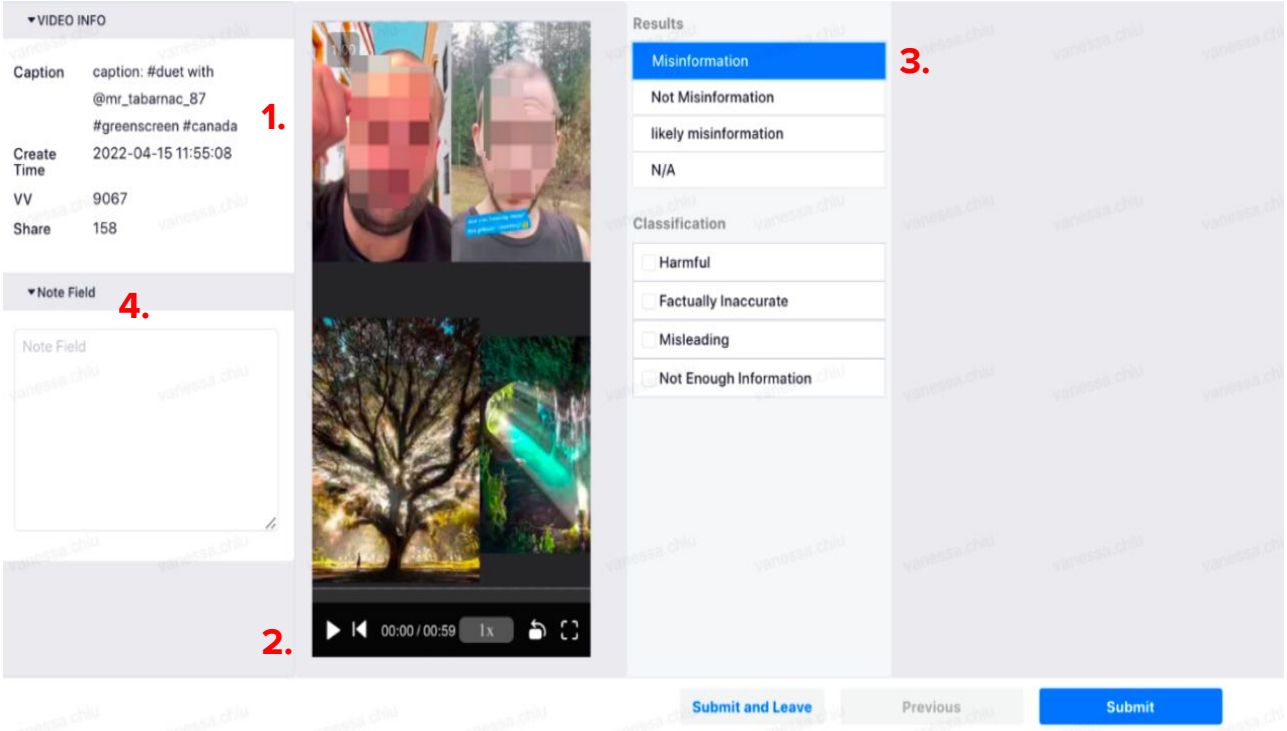
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Fact Checking Queues

TCS Tool Link	https://tcs.tiktokv-us.com/worktable/favor
Fact Checking Queue Name & ID	SF-FC-Spanish Misinformation-US-CMS1.0_TX (7158044436679721474)

Fact Checking Queue

New



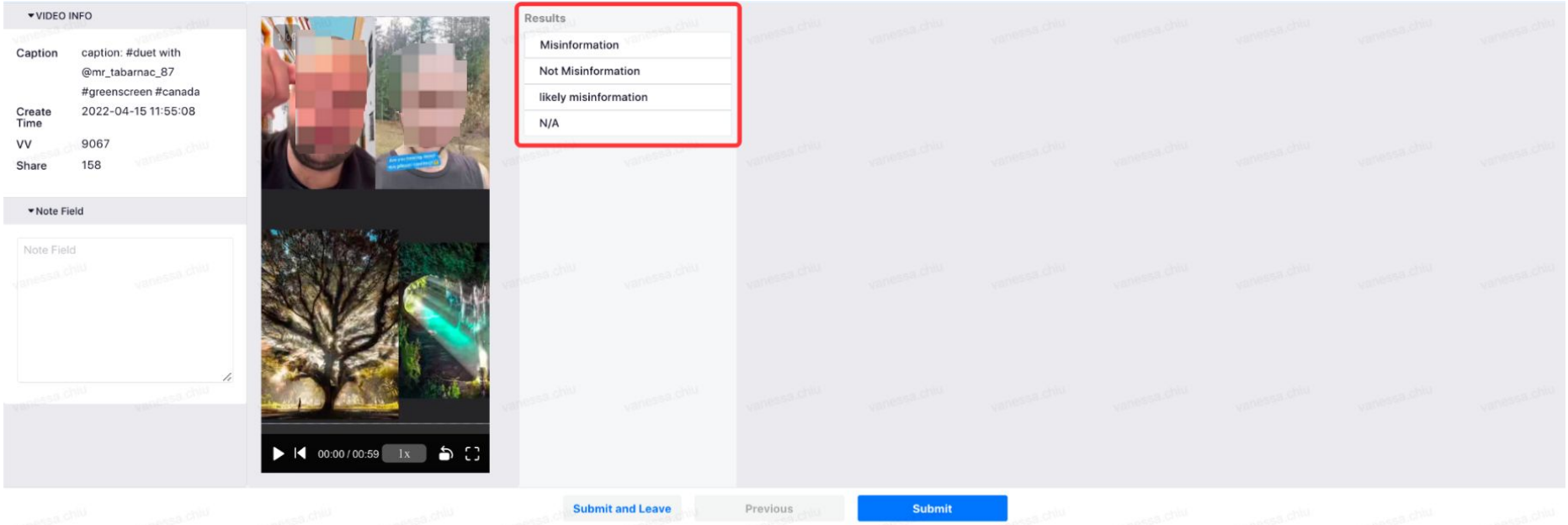
Moderation Workflow:

1. Review the caption
2. Watch the video
3. Select the appropriate Results and Classifications based on the content shown
4. Write the respective notes based on the categories selected in step 3

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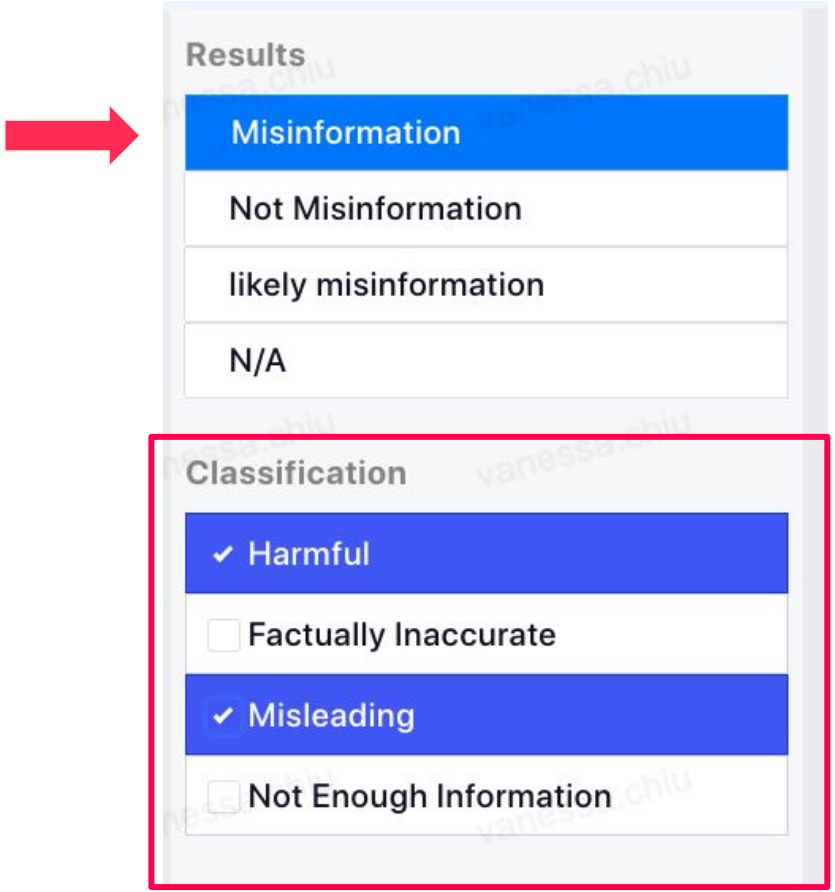
Rating Results/Classifications

New



Classifications

New



Classifications are multi-select

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Classifications

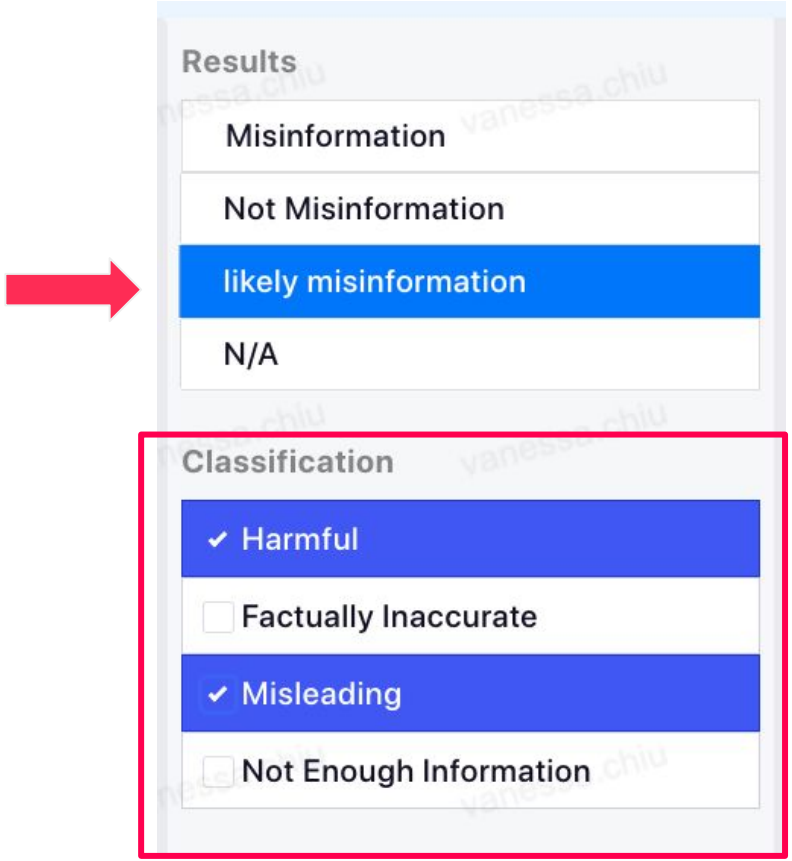
New



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Classifications

New

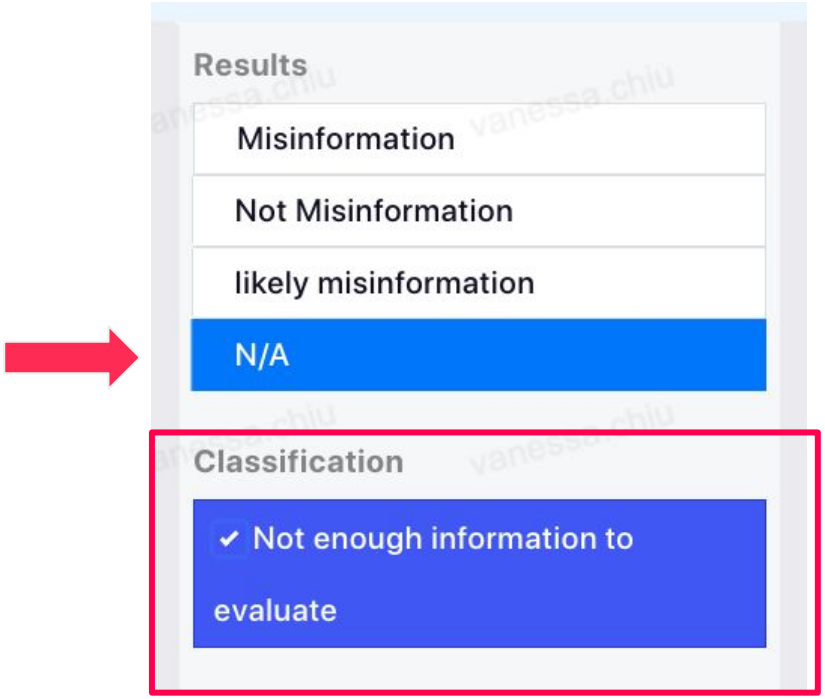


Classifications are multi-select

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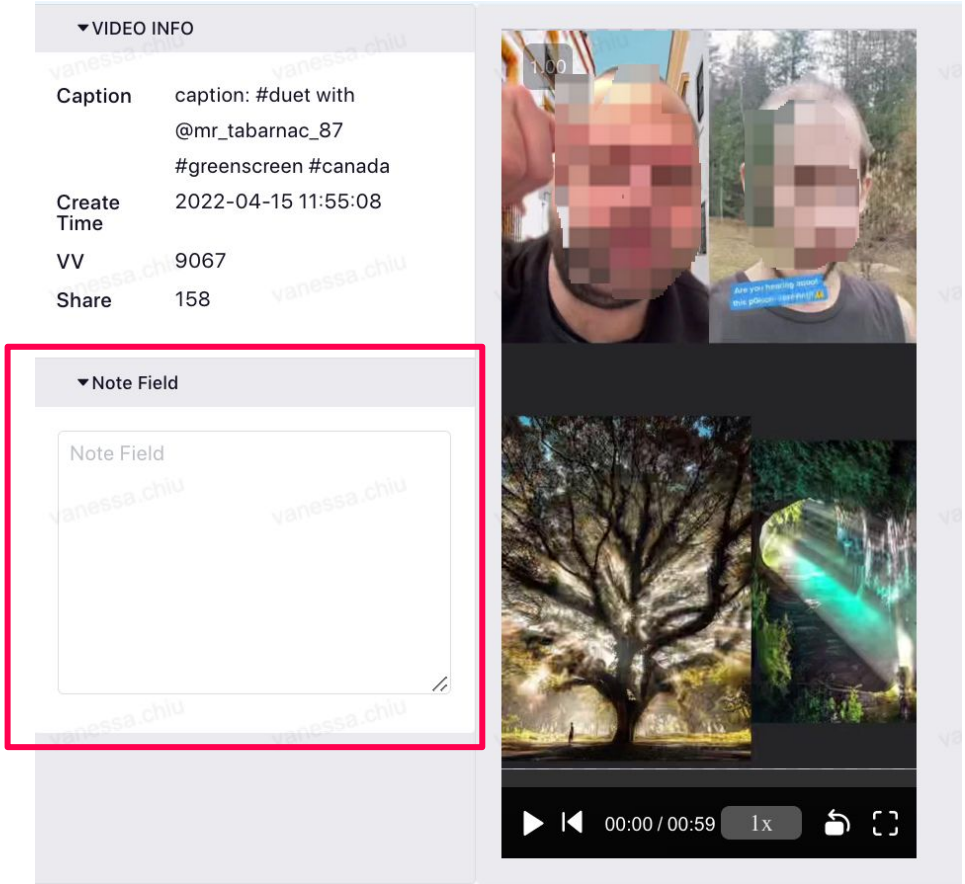
Classifications

New



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Note Field



In the “Note Field”, please include:

1. The claim
2. Decision about claim
3. The reasoning for why the categories on the right are chosen
4. Any URLs that support your decision

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Instructions for Writing Claim in Video

1. State in 1-3 sentences what the video is asserting/claiming. Focus on the claim itself

2. Structure sentence to clearly identify both the claim's associated subject and key action or characteristic. eg. *"X country did Y"* or *"X medication contains Y"*

3. Write the claim in English. If that's not possible, use the relevant market language (generally, this would be the language in the content)

Examples:

1. *The US is hiding biological weapons research in Ukraine as a part of the "Nimble Elder Program."*
2. *GlaxoSmithKline pharmaceutical company owns Pfizer and the Wuhan Institute of Virology, insinuating the company created the Covid-19 virus and its vaccine for financial gain*

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Instructions for Writing Notes

1. Explain in a few sentences why the claim is misinformation, unconfirmed/disputed, or not misinformation

2. If there is evidence that supports why the information is true or false, concisely explain why the research you have reviewed and provided supports the category you selected

3. In instances when a claim lacks supporting evidence, but is too vague, new, or niche to be directly debunked by an authoritative source, state that as such. This also applies to videos that rely solely on an anecdotal perspective (i.e. one individual's experience)

- *Example: "As there is no evidence that President Biden is secretly a "Nazi Space Robot," this claim is misinformation."*

4. Write notes in the relevant market language (generally this would be the language in the content. If unclear, use English.

- *Example: "The Nimble Elder Program is a DoD program intended to locate and track chemical and biological weapons to reduce risk. There is not evidence that it is a weapons program.*
- *Example: "The article provided explains that GlaxoSmithKline does not own Pfizer or the Wuhan Institute"*

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Instructions for how not to write Claim in Video & Notes

1. No need to re-state the rating category or classification selected (i.e. Misinformation, COVID-19 Misinformation)

2. Don’t simply state that the content is true or false - Explain why the evidence supports the category (Misinformation/Unconfirmed/Not Misinformation) selected for the content

3. Generally, don't write more than 5-6 sentences. Conciseness is preferred

4. Don’t include links in the Claim or Notes section. Add link URLs in the "URL" field on the left

5. Don’t editorialize - keep notes straight forward and stick to the facts

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Thank You!

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